

Relationship-Building for Managers

You've probably noticed today's newer team members think about work and respond to leadership differently from you. Here's how to build a relationship that inspires their best.



Invest before you withdraw

Every interaction is a deposit or a withdrawal from a running account. Before you make a hard ask, make sure you've made enough deposits to absorb it. Small, frequent deposits compound.



Seen, Valued, Trusted

An action counts as a deposit only if it makes the person feel:

Seen as a person, not just labor,

Valued for their contribution, or

Trusted with responsibility and judgment

A deposit isn't the same as "being nice." Hollow praise can land as patronizing. Honest, specific critique can land as a deposit.



Tough on Results, Tender on People

You don't have to lower your standards.

Demand excellence on the work; treat the person doing it like a person.